

WAKEUP CALL

The Telangana assembly saw a shower of accusations ahead of its monsoon session, as CM **Revanth Reddy** claimed his predecessor and Leader of Opposition **K. Chandrashekar Rao** drew Rs 1.24 crore in salary over 1,000 days while largely confined to his farmhouse. This, even as the government spent Rs 21 crore on his security, bullet-proof vehicles et al. As the Bharat Rashtra Samithi protested Congress's 1,000 days in office, Revanth called on his partymen to demand KCR's resignation. At a TPCC rally, workers carried posters of KCR as Kumbhakarna, declaring that the 'K' in KCR stood for the mythological character who slept six months.

SUCCESSION SEE-SAW



Ever since **Akash Anand** was declared **Mayawati**'s political heir in December 2023, he has been removed, reinstated, expelled and brought back. On September 3, he got a third demotion in just over two years as the BSP chief removed her 31-year-old nephew as Chief National Coordinator, saying he still needed greater political maturity. Reports had suggested he would help select candidates for the 2027 Uttar Pradesh polls, something Mayawati was reportedly unhappy about. Adding to the intrigue, she introduced Akash's younger brother Ishan Anand to party leaders.



POWER QUEUE

Bihar has had two chief ministers since the assembly polls in November 2025: Nitish Kumar took oath in November, and Samrat Choudhary succeeded him this April. Yet the queue, it seems, has not shortened. At the LJP (Ram Vilas) office in Patna on September 4, national general secretary and MLA Raju Tiwari made the next claim public. With **Chirag Paswan** sitting nearby, he spoke of the party's resolve to make Chirag the next CM. Two days later, Tejashwi Yadav began counting the claimants within the NDA. Samrat's elevation was meant to settle one succession question. Instead, the chief minister's chair has begun to resemble a waiting room.

Kaushik Deka with Rohit Parihar, Prasad Nichenametla, Ashish Misra, Avaneesh Mishra and Amitabh Srivastava

HEALTH WATCH

SOCIAL MEDIA ANXIETY
LOSING SLEEP OVER LIKES

By **Sonali Acharjee**

For teenagers, a post that does not travel as expected may do more than dent confidence—it could also disturb sleep. An August 2026 Indian study of 150 adolescents from Indore, Mumbai, Bengaluru and Pune—published in *The Journal of Theoretical Accounting Research*—examined the gap between the number of likes teenagers hoped to receive and what they actually got. Researchers tracked participants for 30 days using smartwatches, monitoring sleep stages, heart-rate variability, respiratory rate, oxygen saturation and overall sleep scores.

The finding is significant as it shifts the conversation beyond simple screen time. The problem is not only that teenagers stay awake scrolling; it is also that social media creates an emotional state that makes it harder to switch off. When a post attracts fewer likes than expected, researchers suggest that disappointment, self-comparison and anxiety about peer approval can linger after the phone is put down.

For adolescents, whose sense of social identity is still developing, likes can function as a highly visible form of feedback. They perceive a disappointing response as rejection, embarrassment or loss of status among peers. That can encourage repeated checking, deleting and reposting content, or lying awake wondering why others did not respond. Indeed, a separate 2026 Madhya Pradesh study found that 64.7 per cent of young adults aged 18-25 had poor sleep quality. More than a third checked social media immediately after waking, 22.5 per cent had stayed up all night using it, and 7.8 per cent said fewer likes or comments had made them feel anxious or sad.



Experts caution that repeatedly losing or fragmenting sleep can affect concentration, memory, mood regulation and academic performance. It may also make young people more emotionally reactive the following day, potentially creating a cycle in which poor sleep makes online disappointment harder to handle—and online disappointment, in turn, makes good sleep harder to achieve.